

Alliance High School Endowment Fund

Donor FAQ

Updated May 2026. Content reflects AHSEF donor guidance, 2025 year-end reporting, and updated fraud-prevention safeguards for payment instructions.

About AHSEF

What is AHSEF?

The Alliance High School Endowment Fund (AHSEF) is a U.S. **501(c)(3) tax-exempt charitable organization** established to promote academic and overall student excellence at Alliance High School in Kenya. Gifts from U.S. taxpayers may be tax deductible to the extent allowed by law.

AHSEF provides a U.S.-based charitable giving vehicle for supporters who want to contribute to long-term student support, scholarships, sports excellence, need-based assistance, and approved school-related initiatives.

Where are AHSEF funds held and how are they invested?

AHSEF endowment assets are held at Vanguard. AHSEF maintains designated accounts for its approved funds and invests long-term endowment assets with a focus on prudent stewardship, capital preservation where appropriate, and long-term growth.

For security reasons, AHSEF does **not** publish full Vanguard account numbers, bank account numbers, routing numbers, wire instructions, or other sensitive account details online. Donors should contact the Treasurer directly for current transfer instructions.

What funds does AHSEF currently maintain?

Fund	Purpose
Academic Scholarship Endowment Fund	Supports merit-based academic scholarship awards and academic excellence.
Sports Endowment Fund	Supports sports-related awards and student excellence through athletics.
Need-Based Endowment Fund	Supports students with demonstrated financial need, with priority on ensuring that no qualifying Form 4 candidate is sent home because of unpaid school fees.
Multi-Purpose Hall Fund	Receives and disburses U.S.-based contributions designated for the Alliance High School Multi-Purpose Hall project.

What was the size of the AHSEF endowment at year-end 2025?

At December 31, 2025, total AHSEF endowment balances were **\$182,661.94** across four designated funds.

Fund	Year-End Balance as of 12/31/2025
Academic Scholarship Endowment Fund	\$99,264.87

Sports Endowment Fund	\$43,463.49
Need-Based Endowment Fund	\$36,574.37
Multi-Purpose Hall Fund	\$3,359.21
Total AHSEF Endowment Funds	\$182,661.94

Market values fluctuate with investment performance, contributions, and board-approved disbursements.

Giving to AHSEF

What are the ways to give?

Supporters may contribute to AHSEF through the following methods:

- Online giving through the AHSEF donation page.
- Payroll deductions through participating employers.
- ACH, direct deposit, or wire transfer, using current instructions provided directly by the Treasurer.
- Checks made payable to Alliance High School Endowment Fund, using current mailing or deposit instructions provided directly by the Treasurer.
- Employer matching-gift programs.
- Vanguard transfers or gifts of appreciated securities, using current instructions provided directly by AHSEF.

When making a gift, donors should clearly identify the AHSEF fund or purpose they want to support.

Important Security Notice

To protect AHSEF, donors, and the Alliance High School community from fraud, AHSEF does **not** publish full bank account numbers, routing numbers, wire instructions, Vanguard account numbers, or other sensitive account details online.

For ACH, direct deposit, wire transfer, check mailing instructions, Vanguard transfer instructions, or gifts of appreciated securities, please contact:

Jacob Sitati, Treasurer
treasurer@ahsef.org

Please do not rely on payment instructions received from unofficial email addresses, forwarded messages, text messages, WhatsApp messages, or social media accounts. If you are unsure whether any giving instructions are legitimate, please contact the Treasurer before sending funds.

Can I donate online?

Yes. Donors may give securely online through the AHSEF donation page:

www.ahsef.org/donate

Online transaction fees may apply. If available, donors may choose the option that allows AHSEF to receive the full gift by covering or minimizing processing fees.

Suggested designations include: Academic Scholarship Endowment Fund, Sports Endowment Fund, Need-Based Endowment Fund, or Multi-Purpose Hall Fund.

Can I donate by ACH, direct deposit, or wire transfer?

Yes. AHSEF accepts ACH, direct deposit, and wire transfer donations through its official bank account. For current instructions, please contact:

treasurer@ahsef.org

Please include the appropriate fund designation in the memo or reference field when possible.

How do I donate by check?

Checks may be made payable to:

Alliance High School Endowment Fund

Please write the intended fund designation on the memo line. For the current mailing address or deposit instructions, please contact:

treasurer@ahsef.org

Can I donate through Vanguard or give appreciated securities?

Yes. Donors who wish to make gifts directly through Vanguard or transfer appreciated securities should contact AHSEF for current instructions.

For instructions, please contact: **treasurer@ahsef.org**.

Can I give through payroll deductions?

Yes. Many U.S. employers allow employees to support charitable organizations through payroll deductions. If AHSEF is already listed in your employer's giving platform, you may select AHSEF directly and designate your gift to the appropriate fund.

If AHSEF is not listed, please contact **treasurer@ahsef.org** and AHSEF will provide the information needed to help set up the organization in your employer's system.

Can my employer match my gift?

Many U.S. employers offer matching-gift programs for donations to eligible 501(c)(3) nonprofit organizations. Because AHSEF is a U.S. tax-exempt charitable organization, your gift may qualify for a match depending on your employer's policies.

Donors are encouraged to check their employer's giving portal or human resources department to determine whether AHSEF is eligible for matching gifts. Employer matching gifts are an effective way to increase the impact of diaspora giving.

Scholarships, Disbursements, and Governance

How does AHSEF decide scholarship recipients?

AHSEF's historical scholarship model has focused primarily on rewarding academic excellence through merit-based awards. As AHSEF has grown, the board has also developed additional fund categories, including the Sports Endowment Fund and Need-Based Endowment Fund, to support a broader understanding of

student excellence and student need.

Scholarship and disbursement decisions are made by the AHSEF Board in accordance with fund purpose, donor intent, available balances, school-identified needs, and AHSEF's stewardship responsibilities as a U.S. nonprofit organization.

Why did AHSEF initially prioritize merit-based scholarships?

AHSEF's initial focus on merit-based academic scholarships reflected the original benefactor's intent and the organization's early-stage endowment size. A need-based scholarship model typically requires a larger capital base to address student need at scale.

The creation of the Need-Based Endowment Fund allows AHSEF to address financial need more directly while preserving the long-term endowment model.

What is the purpose of the Need-Based Endowment Fund?

The Need-Based Endowment Fund was created to support students with demonstrated financial need at Alliance High School. The fund's current priority is to help ensure that no qualifying Form 4 candidate is sent home because of unpaid school fees. Where resources permit, surplus need-based funds may be used to support students in other classes with verified need.

The AHSEF Board determines the amount to be allocated from the Need-Based Endowment Fund based on available resources, school-verified need, and the board's judgment about where the funds can have the greatest impact.

How does AHSEF approach need-based allocations?

AHSEF's board seeks to use need-based funds in a practical and high-impact manner. Where possible, the board may prioritize students whose fee balances can be fully cleared, because clearing a balance can immediately remove the risk of a student being sent home. Remaining funds may then be applied to other students' balances in a way that makes the largest meaningful dent in outstanding obligations.

The board may also consider proportional or equal allocations depending on the number of students, the size of balances, available funds, and the urgency of the need.

What is the Sports Endowment Fund?

The Sports Endowment Fund supports student excellence through athletics. It reflects AHSEF's broader commitment to academic and overall student excellence, recognizing that sports can build discipline, leadership, teamwork, school pride, and opportunity for students.

Board-approved disbursements from the Sports Endowment Fund may support sports awards, athletics-related student recognition, or other approved sports-related purposes consistent with AHSEF's mission.

What is the Multi-Purpose Hall Fund?

The Multi-Purpose Hall Fund receives U.S.-based contributions designated for the Alliance High School Multi-Purpose Hall project. The Old Boys Club has pledged to fund more than half of the construction of the Multi-Purpose Hall, which is intended to host events and programs that enrich student life at Alliance High School.

AHSEF facilitates the collection of U.S.-based contributions for this project and supports transparent reporting on funds received and disbursed. Donors who wish to support the project should clearly designate their gift to the **Multi-Purpose Hall Fund**.

Can donors direct how their gift is used?

Yes. Donors may designate gifts to one of AHSEF's approved funds, including Academic, Sports, Need-Based, or Multi-Purpose Hall. AHSEF also recognizes directed giving in appropriate circumstances, subject to board approval, AHSEF policies, donor intent, and applicable nonprofit rules.

All gifts must be used in a manner consistent with AHSEF's charitable mission and 501(c)(3) obligations.

How much discretion does the AHSEF Board have over spending?

The AHSEF Board is responsible for stewardship of the organization's funds. This includes preserving the long-term endowment, honoring donor designations, making prudent investment and spending decisions, and ensuring that disbursements are consistent with AHSEF's charitable purpose.

The board seeks to maintain transparency by sharing financial summaries, fund balances, and major disbursement activity with donors and the Alliance High School community.

Why are there multiple initiatives supporting Alliance High School?

Alliance High School benefits from multiple alumni, donor, and institutional initiatives. AHSEF recognizes that this can sometimes create donor fatigue or confusion.

AHSEF's role is distinct: it provides a U.S.-based 501(c)(3) endowment structure designed for long-term, transparent, and tax-deductible giving. AHSEF's endowment model is intended to complement, not compete with, other school-support initiatives. Where feasible, AHSEF seeks alignment with school priorities and other alumni-led efforts.

Transparency and Reporting

How does AHSEF report financial performance and activity?

AHSEF provides periodic financial reports showing fund balances, contributions received, investment performance, disbursements, transfers, and major administrative or operational updates.

AHSEF's reports are intended to help donors understand how funds are being managed and how resources are being used to support Alliance High School students. AHSEF will make relevant account information and periodic balance updates available through AHSEF communications and/or the AHSEF website, while excluding sensitive account details from public posting.

What major cash activity occurred in 2025?

- Total AHSEF endowment balances reached **\$182,661.94** at year-end 2025.
- AHSEF established an operating bank account to support administration and facilitate certain types of contributions.
- The operating account was funded by a **\$2,000 transfer** from the Academic Scholarship Endowment Fund.
- AHSEF made a **\$3,000 disbursement** from the Multi-Purpose Hall Fund for AHSEF-aligned purposes while maintaining the minimum balance needed to keep the fund open.
- AHSEF facilitated a one-time **\$10,000 restricted pass-through gift** to a Kenya-based Endowment Fund Trust, separate from typical AHSEF disbursement practices.

Are AHSEF funds invested permanently?

AHSEF is designed as an endowment, which means the organization seeks to preserve and grow principal over time while making prudent disbursements for approved purposes. The board may approve withdrawals or disbursements consistent with AHSEF's policies, donor intent, fund purpose, and the organization's long-term sustainability.

Are donations tax deductible?

Yes. AHSEF is a U.S. 501(c)(3) tax-exempt charitable organization. Donations from U.S. taxpayers are generally tax deductible to the extent allowed by law. Donors should consult their own tax advisor regarding their specific circumstances.

Can AHSEF provide donation acknowledgments?

Yes. AHSEF can provide donation acknowledgments or receipts for donor records. For questions about donation confirmation, tax acknowledgments, employer matching documentation, or fund designations, please contact **treasurer@ahsef.org**.

More Information

For questions about giving, fund designations, payroll setup, ACH/direct deposit, wire transfers, matching gifts, Vanguard transfers, or gifts of appreciated securities, please contact:

Jacob Sitati, Treasurer

Grieve House, Class of 1995

treasurer@ahsef.org

www.ahsef.org